



Wadhvani Ignite

CONCEPT BOOKLET

Module 3

Lesson 1: Examine Ideation Techniques

Context:

When developing solutions, it's tempting to quickly act on the first idea that comes to mind. However, creating effective and innovative solutions demands a structured approach to idea generation. In this lesson, "Generating Solution Ideas," we will learn to systematically brainstorm and refine solutions that not only address the identified problems but also resonate with our customers. This methodical process is vital for developing viable, impactful, and customer-centric solutions, crucial for standing out and succeeding in the market.

Program overview, and your **Venture Journey** over 14 weeks

1. Problem Identification	2. Customer Identification & Needs Validation	3. Solution Idea Generation
Week 1-2	Weeks 2-4	Week 4
■ Orientation ■ Develop Macro Industry-Problem view ■ Assemble “Real-World” Problems ■ Examine Chosen Problems ■ Analyze Problems	■ Identify customer segments ■ Assess 'jobs-to-be-done' ■ Develop Customer Personas ■ Understand Customer Validation ■ Validate Customer-Problem fit ■ Pivot/Refine Customer-Problem Fit for Feasibility	■ Understand Ideation techniques ■ Generate Solution Idea
4. Opportunity & Competition Mapping	5. Prototype Development & MVP	6. Opportunity Feasibility Assessment & Sizing
Week 5	Week 6	Week 7-8
■ Identify Global competitors ■ Review Industry Trends and Estimate Market Size (TAM) ■ Introduction to Financial Planning	■ Overview of Prototypes & MVP ■ Build an Initial Prototype ■ Prototype for Early Validation	■ Map your Relative Position in the Market ■ Estimate Opportunity Size
7. Business Modelling	8. Marketing & Sales Strategy	9. Financial Management for Profitability
Week 8-9	Week 9-10	Week 11-12
■ Examine Revenue Model ■ Revenue Models continued ■ Review and Organize the Lean Canvas ■ Build the LC for your Startup	■ Understand Marketing & Sales ■ Recommend a Go-To-Market (GTM) Approach ■ Map a Sales Process	■ Deep Dive into Financial Planning ■ Analyze the Path to Profitability ■ Understand Bootstrapping and Funding Options
10. Team & Talent Requirement	11. Orientation for Scale	12. Venture Idea Feasibility Presentation
Week 12	Week 13	Week 14
■ Finding Co-founders and Mentors ■ Building an Initial Team	■ Thinking Beyond the Prototype - Scale Opportunity & Orientation ■ Persuasive Story-Telling for a Viable Venture Idea ■ Pitch preparation	■ Practice Pitch ■ Final Pitches

Core Concepts Covered in this Lesson:

Overview of Brainstorming: Understand the fundamental concept of brainstorming as a collaborative technique aimed at generating multiple ideas within a limited timeframe. Explore how brainstorming facilitates divergent thinking and fosters creativity in solution ideation.

Brainstorming Guidelines: Explore guidelines for effective brainstorming sessions, including the importance of suspending judgment, prioritizing quantity over quality, building on ideas, encouraging wild ideas, maintaining focus on the problem, and setting time constraints. Learn how adherence to these guidelines enhances the productivity and creativity of brainstorming sessions.

After completing this lesson, you will be able to:

- 1. Appreciate the Benefits of Ideating in Your Teams:** Gain insight into the advantages of collaborative ideation within teams, including enhanced creativity, diverse perspectives, and the ability to generate a wide range of solution ideas.
- 2. Master the Ground Rules:** Familiarize yourself with the ground rules of effective brainstorming, including suspending judgment, prioritizing quantity, building on ideas, encouraging wild ideas, maintaining focus, and adhering to time constraints.
- 3. Apply Solution Brainstorming Based on the Problem Your Team has Identified:** Apply the learned principles of brainstorming to practice solution ideation based on the specific problem your team has identified. Utilize the brainstorming guidelines to

generate multiple ideas and explore potential solutions without prematurely settling on a single concept.

Steps for you to take:

Understand Brainstorming and apply it to your problem statement

Generate as many solution ideas as possible.

Benefits of Ideating in Your Teams using the Brainstorming technique

Brainstorming is a collaborative idea-generation technique where team members share and discuss ideas freely without immediate criticism or judgment. The goal is to foster creativity and gather a wide range of potential solutions to a problem.

It typically involves the team coming together setting clear objectives, and encouraging participation from all team members.

Team ideation leads to the generation of multiple ideas, ensuring that the team has a wide array of solutions to choose from.

Incorporating diverse perspectives prevents the team from being confined to a single way of thinking, encouraging a broader and more rounded approach to problem-solving. This diversity in thought helps the team explore various directions, increasing the likelihood of finding the most effective solution. Consequently, team members can compare and refine these multiple ideas, ultimately selecting the best possible solution to address the problem comprehensively.

Many organizations have effectively utilized brainstorming to generate successful ideas. Let's explore some examples and use cases to understand how brainstorming can be leveraged effectively.

Product Innovation:

Example: Tech companies like Google use brainstorming to develop new features and products. For instance, Google's "20% Time" policy allows employees to spend 20% of their time working on any project they choose, leading to innovations like Gmail and Google News.

Use Case: Teams can brainstorm to identify new product features, improve existing products, or create entirely new product lines based on customer feedback and market trends.

Marketing:

Example: Advertising agencies often hold brainstorming sessions to generate creative campaign ideas. A famous example is the "Share a Coke" campaign by Coca-Cola, which personalized bottles with popular names, increasing sales and customer engagement.

Use Case: Brainstorming helps marketing teams come up with innovative campaign ideas, social media strategies, and promotional activities that resonate with target audiences.

Cost Optimization:

Example: Manufacturing companies like Toyota use brainstorming techniques as part of their Kaizen approach to continuous improvement. Employees suggest ways to reduce waste, improve efficiency, and cut costs.

Use Case: Teams can brainstorm to identify areas where costs can be reduced without compromising quality, such as streamlining processes, renegotiating supplier contracts, or finding alternative materials.

Hiring:

Example: Companies like Zappos use brainstorming sessions to refine their hiring processes, making them more efficient and effective. They focus on creating a unique company culture that attracts top talent.

Use Case: HR teams can brainstorm to develop new recruitment strategies, improve the candidate experience, and enhance employee retention programs.

Ground Rules for Brainstorming

Here are the general rules for effective brainstorming

Define the Problem: Clearly articulate the issue you aim to solve to ensure everyone understands the focus of the brainstorming session.

Select a Diverse Group: Choose participants from various backgrounds and areas of expertise to bring different perspectives and ideas.

Set Ground Rules: Establish guidelines to ensure a respectful, open, and productive environment where all ideas are welcomed.

Choose a Facilitator: Appoint someone to guide the session, keep the discussion on track, and ensure that everyone participates.

Generate Ideas: Encourage all participants to share their ideas freely without fear of criticism or judgment.

Do Not Evaluate: Refrain from evaluating or critiquing ideas during the brainstorming phase to maintain a flow of creativity.

Group and Categorize: Organize the generated ideas into categories or themes

Call to Action

Complete Venture Activity 3.1- Generate Solution Ideas

Review your team's problem statement. Think about your customer segments (primary and secondary). What types of solutions will delight customers? Which solutions will address their problems, and help with their JTBD?

Brainstorm Ideas: Once you're familiar with the problem statements, and your customer segments, start brainstorming!

Defer Judgment: Encourage all ideas, no matter how unconventional.

Go for Quantity: Aim to generate as many ideas as possible within the time limit.

Build on Ideas: Encourage each other to build upon and combine ideas to create new concepts.

Encourage Wild Ideas: Don't be afraid to think outside the box and explore unconventional solutions.

Collaborate with Your Peers: Discuss your ideas with your classmates. Share your thoughts and listen to theirs. You might discover new perspectives or build upon each other's ideas. You can also use Chat GPT to refine your ideas.

Capture Your Ideas: Write down your brainstormed ideas on sticky notes, on a whiteboard, or in your notebook. Make sure they're visible and easy to reference later.

Choose the TOP Ideas: From the list of generated ideas, select **THREE** that appear the most relevant and unique

Reflect on the Process: Take a moment to reflect on the brainstorming session. What ideas stood out to you? Which ones do you think have the most potential?